

Chandralal, chief coach of the Indian women's boxing team, Jaismine's soft-spoken, deferential nature was at odds with the boldness needed in the ring.

She says she consciously worked on it. "Everyone has their own personality. For some, aggression comes naturally; for others, you have to work on it. I think my calmness helps me think clearly under pressure, but I understood I needed to be more aggressive in the ring too. Before the bout I had to tell myself, 'I must show more aggression'. I wasn't able to before. I used to just back-pedal. It didn't look good to the judges, and I've lost a lot of close fights for this reason. I had to constantly remind myself: 'You aren't being aggressive, you aren't being aggressive,'" she says.

Jaismine isn't the first Indian athlete to retool her personality. Before the 2016 Olympics, badminton coach Pullela Gopichand had P. V. Sindhu yell at him in training to bring her out of her shell. For Jaismine, the breakthrough came through training methods. "My coaches wouldn't make me yell at them, but they would keep pushing me, saying 'you can do it, you can do it'. What helped most was training against boys at the Army Sports Institute. The only way to last in the ring against them was by being aggressive. There was no other option," she says.

She has also looked beyond the ring to build mental strength.

"I've started writing down my goals and charting my preparation. I've also started practising manifestation daily. Six months ago, I wrote down for the first time, 'Thank you universe for making me the World Champion'. I kept believing in it until it happened," she says.

Everything came together at the World Championships in Liverpool. Even though she faced a tough draw, Jaismine says she wasn't thinking about the field or the result. "I went in with confidence. I had trained well. I wasn't thinking about the result because I knew I would come from pressure. I focused on implementing

the training I had done," she says.

Now she has her sights set on more. "I have written one more thing in my manifestation journal. I won't say more about it until I accomplish it," she laughs. It isn't hard to guess. "Next year, we have the Commonwealth and Asian Games. I want to do well in both," she says.

It won't be easy. As the reigning World Champion, Jaismine is no longer flying under the radar. Opponents will study her style and prepare for her.

That doesn't bother her. "There will be extra pressure on me as a World Champion and as someone people want to beat. The main thing is how to improve my performance. Because the more we are afraid of anything, the more it affects our preparation. I'll continue to prepare and correct the mistakes I've made."



Picture-perfect: (From left) Julia Szeremeta of Poland, Jaismine Lamboria of India, Alcala Cegovia of Venezuela and Valeria Arboleda Mendoza of Colombia pose with the medals following the World Boxing Championships finals. GETTY IMAGES

World Champion or not, she admits she still has plenty to improve. "I've achieved one thing, but I can't stop here. I can work more on getting stronger. I've had some good fights and was aggressive like I wanted to be at the World Championships, but I can be even more attacking. I also want to punch more and with more power. There are technical areas I can make more *mazbut* (stronger). My 2025 has gone well, but 2026 is very important," she says.